

# CLICK BAIT

WITH THE FESTIVE MOODS AND SEASONS KICKING INTO TOP GEAR LEADING TOWARDS THE END OF A FABULOUS YEAR, WE DECIDED TO GIVE YOU A COMPREHENSIVE BUYING GUIDE OF CAMERAS, AND HOW TO PICK UP THE RIGHT ACCESSORIES THAT WILL ENHANCE YOUR PHOTOGRAPHY SKILLS

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**A**s much as smartphone cameras may advance in clarity, controls and resolution count, standalone cameras will forever rule the world of imaging. And there are accessories that will aid your photography pursuits.

What you would need, and want, is dependant on the amount of money you are ready to spend, your use cases, and your skill level in photography. Let's break it down for you.

## TYPES OF CAMERAS

Broadly, the consumer segment is divided into three types of cameras – point-and-shoot (or, compact), mirrorless, and digital single lens reflex (DSLR) cameras. Speaking on general terms, a compact camera is the easiest standalone imaging product to operate. They, however, give restricted options to play around with. With the passage of time, the compact cameras have grown in stature, nowadays providing decent image quality, along with more controls to toggle with. There is a new sub-range of cameras, termed as advanced point-and-shoot cameras. These cameras mostly include lenses of high zoom capabilities, and are ideal for beginners for getting used to high telephoto imaging. However, at the end of the day, these cameras are mostly for parties, vacations, and other casual occasions that don't require photography know-how.

Mirrorless cameras offer an upgraded imaging mechanism, fast focusing, and

the option of getting interchangeable lenses for a compact, lightweight camera body. However, these mirrorless cameras are packing in large sensors and DSLR-grade builds.



**More control than everything else!**

The digital SLR cameras of the present day, along with a host of automatic/semi-automatic shooting options, have complete manual shooting capabilities, coupled with support for a wide range of accessories.

## HOW EACH FARE

Compact cameras are lightweight no-frills devices that you can easily stow away in your satchel purse and a number of them run on the power of pencil batteries, which many find convenient.

The mirrorless cameras have advanced mechanisms, and their performance is close to that of DSLRs. This, with the added advantage of being lightweight, makes them a formidable offering. The mirrorless cameras are for you, if you

have your mind fixed on a considerable upgrade over your existing smartphone/compact/basic DSLR cameras. Also, most of them use contrast-based focusing, which is considerably slower than the phase-detection autofocus used in DSLRs, which also happen to be more accurate. Alongside, battery life is yet another section where the DSLRs triumph over the mirrorless cameras, seeing that the live viewfinders of the mirrorless cameras consume a lot of power, while DSLRs can survive without live viewfinders. The presence of a bigger body on DSLRs also allow companies to put more buttons and dials, which further aid usability.

Having spoken about the differences, mirrorless cameras and DSLRs provide almost equal photograph and video quality, employing bigger and more advanced sensors than compact cameras. The issue here boils down to the range of interchangeable lenses and their qualities, where DSLRs have a clear upper hand. It is for this reason that most professionals choose DSLRs over the mirrorless.

## THE BRAND DILEMMA

While it is hard to reason against personal preferences, here are a few factors that you need to consider. Canon has a wide array of lenses but Nikon has its own unique advantages that doesn't only extend up to its popular F-mount.

From what we have seen, Nikon's colour reproduction in photography is better than Canon.